

Team Discussion - Post-Mortem - Process Change

Title: Q4 System Failure Review and Prevention Strategy Participants: Engineering Leads, Product Manager (PM), QA Lead Duration: 75 minutes

(Transcript Start)

Lead: "The focus is the Q4 outage. The root cause was a conflict between the deployment script and a scheduled database index rebuild. The outage lasted four hours. We had three main options to restore service: A) Rollback the entire DB, B) Kill the index rebuild and redeploy the code, or C) Rollback the code only. The decision was Option C: Rollback the code only and halt the index rebuild manually. The rationale was simple: it was the lowest-risk option with the fastest recovery time, avoiding potential data corruption. The main concern raised during the incident was the lack of visibility into the index rebuild status."

PM: "We spent 25 minutes of this meeting talking about the holiday party, which was totally unnecessary. I think that entire segment could have been a quick Slack poll. But on the core topic, I have a concern: if we decide to roll out a new monitoring dashboard, who will maintain it?"

QA Lead: "That's a valid concern. Decision 2 is to create a new monitoring dashboard focused solely on DB health and assign ownership to the Infra Team. The rationale is that the current dashboard is too noisy. Decision 3 is to update the deployment pipeline to check for scheduled DB maintenance before any new deployment. Mike will own the implementation of that check, and he will have it done by the 15th of next month."

Lead: "Perfect. This meeting was necessary, but only the 45 minutes focused on the decisions and actions. The alignment on the monitoring dashboard was critical and required all three parties to agree on the ownership and scope."

(Transcript End)